UNIT 5: DIGITAL PRESENTATION

LibreOffice Impress • Class IX IT (402) • Theory Notes

1. FEATURES & ELEMENTS OF AN EFFECTIVE PRESENTATION

- **Digital Presentation:** The practice of presenting and communicating information, project proposals, ideas, or educational concepts clearly using computer software.
- **Slide:** An individual page or screen of a presentation. A sequential display of slides is called a **Slide Show**.
- **Elements of a Presentation:** Regular text, structured lists, data tables, digital graphics/images, audio, video clips, animations, and slide transitions.
- **Characteristics of an Effective Presentation:**
  - **Number of Lines:** Limit to **5 to 8 lines** per slide. Crowded text makes reading difficult.
  - **Font Size:** Keep text readable from a distance (recommended: titles 40–44 pt, body text **≥ 32 pt**).
  - **Grammar & Language:** Slides must be proofread and error-free to ensure correct communication.
  - **Graphics Balance:** Limit to a maximum of **2 graphics** (images, tables, or charts) per slide to avoid clutter.
  - **Colour & Contrast:** Use dark fonts on light backgrounds (or vice versa). Avoid harsh all-red text.
  - **Animation Control:** Use subtle animations; avoid multiple simultaneous media clips that distract listeners.

2. CREATE A PRESENTATION (LIBREOFFICE IMPRESS BASICS)

- **LibreOffice Impress:** A Free and Open-Source Software (FOSS) used to create digital presentations. Default file extension is **.odp** (OpenDocument Presentation).
- **Starting Impress:** Launch from Start Menu / Application Launcher → *LibreOffice Impress*.
- **Key Window Parts:**
  - **Title Bar:** Displays document name (e.g., *Untitled 1.odp*) and window control buttons.
  - **Menu Bar:** Contains menus: File, Edit, View, Insert, Format, Slide, Slide Show, Tools, Window, Help.
  - **Slide Pane:** Left vertical panel showing miniature thumbnails of all slides for quick navigation.
  - **Workspace:** Central area where slides are designed, text is typed, and objects are inserted.
  - **Sidebar (Tasks Pane):** Right panel holding *Master Pages, Layouts, Animation,* and *Transitions*.
  - **Status Bar:** Bottom bar displaying slide numbers, template style, and zoom control slider.
- **Basic Presentation Operations:**
  - **New from Template:** `File -> New -> Presentation` (or `Ctrl + N`) → pick a template → click *Open*.
  - **Save Presentation:** `File -> Save` (or **Ctrl + S**). To save under another format/name, use `File -> Save As` (`Shift + Ctrl + S`).
  - **Exporting:** `File -> Export as` PDF (creates non-editable PDF) or `File -> Export` (HTML web format).
  - **Running Slide Show:** Press **F5** (starts from first slide) or **Shift + F5** (starts from current slide). Exit show with **Esc**.
  - **Closing:** Close document with **Ctrl + W**; exit Impress application with **Ctrl + Q**. Help is opened with **F1**.

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3. WORK WITH SLIDES & WORKSPACE VIEWS

- **Insert New Slide:** Press **Ctrl + M**, or select `Slide -> New Slide`, or click the *New Slide* icon on the toolbar.
- **Insert Duplicate Slide:** Select slide thumbnail in Slide Pane → choose `Slide -> Duplicate Slide` to create an identical copy.
- **Slide Layout:** The arrangement of content boxes on a slide. Selected via the *Layouts* section in the Sidebar (e.g., Title Slide, Title & Content).
- **Slide Management:**
  - *Delete:* Select slide thumbnail in Slide Pane and press the **Delete** key.
  - *Rename:* Right-click thumbnail → select **Rename Slide** → enter new name.
  - *Rearrange:* Use mouse drag-and-drop to move slides up or down in the Slide Pane.
  - *Cut / Copy / Paste:* Standard keys `Ctrl + X`, `Ctrl + C`, and `Ctrl + V`.
- **Workspace Views (View Menu):**
  - **Normal View:** The primary editing view used to design and format individual slides.
  - **Outline View:** Displays all slide titles and text in hierarchical text format without graphics.
  - **Notes View:** Displays the slide with a lower section to type speaker reference notes.
  - **Slide Sorter View:** Displays miniature thumbnails of all slides in grid rows; ideal for sorting and timing.

4. FORMAT TEXT & APPLY ANIMATIONS

- **Formatting Toolbar:** Modify font name, font size, bold (`Ctrl + B`), italic (`Ctrl + I`), underline (`Ctrl + U`), font color, and text highlight color.
- **Text Alignment:** Left (`Ctrl + L`), Center (`Ctrl + E`), Right (`Ctrl + R`), Justified (`Ctrl + J`), and vertical alignment (Top, Center, Bottom).
- **Character Effects:** Superscript raises text (`Ctrl + Shift + P`; e.g., 1st); Subscript lowers text (`Ctrl + Shift + B`; e.g., CO_2).
- **Bullets & Numbering:** Organizes sentences into clean unordered bullets or ordered numbered points.
- **Custom Animation:** Movement and audio effects applied to *individual elements inside a slide* (text, shapes, pictures).
  - *Steps:* Select the object → open **Custom Animation** in Sidebar → click **Add (+)**.
  - *Effect Categories:* **Entrance** (how element appears), **Emphasis** (grows/spins), **Exit** (how element leaves), and **Motion Paths**.

5. CREATE AND USE TABLES

- **Insert Table:** Select `Insert -> Table` (or Table icon on Standard Toolbar). Set the required number of columns and rows.
- **Data Navigation:** Move through cells using **Tab**, **Arrow Keys**, or mouse click. Pressing Tab in the bottom-right cell creates a new row.
- **Selecting Elements:**
  - *Row / Column:* Hover mouse at table border until cursor turns into a slanted arrow, then drag across.
  - *Entire Table:* Click on the external boundary of the table.
- **Resize Dimensions:** Drag grid divider lines when cursor turns to ↔ (column width) or ↕ (row height).
- **Table Properties:** Right-click table → select **Table Properties** to configure borders, line styles, padding, and background shading.

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6. INSERT AND FORMAT IMAGES & DRAWING OBJECTS

- **Insert Image from File:** Go to `Insert -> Image` → browse computer directory → select picture file → click **Open**.
- **Insert Image from Gallery:** Go to `Insert -> Media -> Gallery` (or Gallery icon in Sidebar). Pick a theme, select an image, and drag it onto the slide.
- **Formatting Images:**
  - *Move:* Click on the image (cursor turns into a hand icon) and drag to the desired position.
  - *Resize:* Click to show selection handles; drag corner handles to maintain width-to-height aspect ratio.
  - *Rotate:* Click the *Rotate* tool on the toolbar; drag corner handles in any circular angle.
- **Drawing Graphic Objects:** Select shapes (lines, arrows, rectangles, stars, flowcharts, callouts) from the **Drawing Toolbar**; drag on workspace to draw.
- **Grouping & Ungrouping Objects:**
  - **Group (Ctrl + Shift + G):** Select multiple drawn objects (holding `Shift`) → `Format -> Group -> Group`. Combines them into a single movable entity.
  - **Ungroup (Ctrl + Alt + Shift + G):** `Format -> Group -> Ungroup` restores grouped shapes back into independent objects.

7. WORK WITH SLIDE MASTER & TRANSITIONS

- **Slide Master:** A master slide that controls the basic design architecture (default background colour, font theme, bullet style, and logos) for all slides in the presentation.
  - Ensures uniform visual consistency across the entire slide deck.
  - Accessed from the **Master Pages** section in the Sidebar. A presentation can have more than one slide master.
- **Slide Transition:** Visual effects that appear when moving from one slide to the next during a slide show.
  - *Steps:* Select slide(s) in Slide Pane → open **Slide Transition** section in Sidebar → pick an effect (e.g., Fade, Wipe, Wheel).
  - *Transition Settings:* Adjust speed (Slow, Medium, Fast), attach sound, or check **Loop until next sound**.
  - *Advance Slide:* Choose between **On mouse click** (manual advance) or **Automatically after [N] sec**.
  - Click **Apply Transition to All Slides** to apply the transition throughout the deck.

> **Important Summary Points for Exams:**
> • Default extension of Impress file is **.odp**.
> • The first slide of a presentation is typically the **Title Slide**.
> • Shortcut for New Slide is **Ctrl + M**; for Slide Show is **F5**; to end presentation is **Esc**.
> • Best practice: **5 to 8 lines** per slide; body font size **≥ 32 pt**.
> • **Custom Animation** applies to elements inside a slide; **Slide Transition** applies to slide switching.
> • Printed copies of slides provided to the audience are called **Handouts**.

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